

SoDamHarness README.en

SoDamHarness — An AI Seatbelt for Absolute Beginners

A “seatbelt” that helps prevent big accidents when you code with AI (Claude Code). Even if development, AI, and computers are all new to you, **just follow along**.

⚠️ **Honest promise:** It is a “seatbelt” that blocks common dangers — **not a “bulletproof shield.”** There is no “100% safe.”

What it does for you

- 🛔 **Very dangerous actions** (deleting a whole folder, etc.) are **blocked**.
- 💾 Before **hard-to-undo actions** (deleting/overwriting files): **auto-backup** + “Really do this?” prompt.
- ↩️ Made a mistake? **Restore from backup** (`/sodam-harness-undo`).
- 🔒 Passwords/tokens are **never touched or backed up**.
- 🗣️ All guidance in **plain, easy language**.

Prerequisites (free, 2 things)

1. **Node.js** (v18+) — if missing, install **LTS** from <https://nodejs.org>.
2. **Claude Code** — if you’re reading this in Claude Code, you already have it.

How to download SoDamHarness

Current method — install from a folder on your computer:

1. You should have received the SoDamHarness folder from the developer (or downloaded it via a direct link).
2. Copy that folder to a permanent location: your **Documents** folder or **Desktop** is a good choice.
3. Note the full path to the folder — you will need it during installation.
 - **Windows tip:** In File Explorer, click the address bar at the top of the window to see and copy the full path.

- **Mac tip:** Right-click the folder, hold **Option**, and choose "Copy [folder name] as Pathname."

When publicly released on GitHub (not yet available):

1. Go to: `https://github.com/sodam-ai/SoDam-Harness-Eng`
2. Click the green `<> Code` button → **"Download ZIP"**
3. Extract the ZIP file (right-click → "Extract All..." on Windows; double-click on Mac)
4. Use the extracted folder path during installation

 Full download instructions with step-by-step screenshots descriptions: [GUIDE.en.md](#) §1-1

Quick install (once)

1. In Claude Code, type `/plugin` → **Add marketplace**.
2. Enter the source:
 - Published (recommended): `sodam-ai/SoDam-Harness-Eng`
 - From your computer folder (current): the full folder path (e.g., `D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_22d_SoDam-Harness-Eng`)
3. **Install `sodam-harness`** → **fully quit and reopen** Claude Code.
4. Type `/sodam-harness` → if commands appear, success. Then run `/sodam-harness-install` .

 If not yet published to GitHub, **install via the folder path**. (Full steps & troubleshooting: [GUIDE.en.md](#))

Internal structure (at a glance)

Every AI action passes through SoDamHarness before it executes:

[You] → [Claude Code] → [SoDamHarness checks] → [Action runs or is stopped]

The three components:

Component	File	Role
Guard	<code>hooks/guard.mjs</code>	Checks every AI action before it runs. Decides: block, backup+ask, or allow.
Backup Keeper	<code>hooks/backup.mjs</code>	Makes a safe copy of a file before any risky

Component	File	Role
		action happens.
Logger	hooks/activity.mjs	Records what the AI did (filename + time only — never content or secrets).

3-tier risk classification:

Tier	Name	What happens	Examples
 Safe	Passes through	Runs immediately, no interruption	Creating files, reading, normal edits
 Risky	Backup + Confirmation	Backup made → “Really do this?” prompt	File deletion, overwrite, deploy
 Catastrophic	Immediately blocked	Refused entirely, never executed	<code>rm -rf</code> , deleting whole folders, system folder deletion

 Full architecture diagram with data flow: [GUIDE.en.md](#) §0-1

Commands

Command	Description
<code>/sodam-harness-install</code>	Confirms install + getting-started guide
<code>/sodam-harness-status</code>	Current state + what to do next (self-check)
<code>/sodam-harness-fix</code>	Symptom-based help when something breaks
<code>/sodam-harness-undo</code>	Undo (restore by picking from the backup list)
<code>/sodam-harness-trust</code>	“Stop asking for this folder/action” — silence it for this session (hard blocks & backups still apply)
<code>/sodam-harness-log</code>	“What did you just do?” — timeline of AI actions (names & time only; secrets masked)

2 skills (auto): `/sodam-harness-beginner-tone` (easy tone) · `/sodam-harness-self-check` (verify before "done").

💡 All commands are **Claude Code only**. To use it with **Codex**, see "(Optional) Using it with Codex" in the [GUIDE](#).

Safety behavior at a glance

What the AI tries	Seatbelt
Create / read / normal edits	Proceeds
Delete a whole folder · dangerous system commands	Blocked
Delete / overwrite a file	Backup + Confirm
Passwords / tokens / auth files	Not touched

- Backups: `~/.sodamharness/backups/` · on mistakes, `/sodam-harness-undo` .
- In "auto-approve" mode the prompt may be skipped (backups still happen).
- No data is ever sent outside your computer. All features run locally.

If something goes wrong

- Commands don't appear → **fully quit and reopen** Claude Code (plugins load at startup).
- "Node.js missing" → install **LTS** from <https://nodejs.org>, then restart.
- Deleted by mistake → `/sodam-harness-undo` .
- More detail → `/sodam-harness-fix` or [GUIDE.en.md](#) §8.

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Honest limits

- An **auxiliary safety aid** that reduces common risks — **not perfect** (new risk patterns can be missed).
- **Verified on Windows · Mac untested.**
- For truly important data, don't rely on this tool alone — **keep separate backups.**

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